

TERRIFYING TYRANT

TYRANNOSAURUS

SHARP CLAWS

Tyrannosaurus had large, sharp claws on the ends of its forearms. While paleontologists still debate the possible purpose of the tiny arms, some have suggested that *Tyrannosaurus* could have used its claws to clasp struggling prey.



Large, deadly, bipedal theropods called tyrannosaurids, which had massive skulls, sharp teeth, and powerful bodies, became the dominant carnivores in the Northern Hemisphere by the Late Cretaceous Period. Of all the terrifying creatures in this family, *Tyrannosaurus* was probably the biggest and most fearsome. Known from more than 50 well-preserved fossils, it is one of the best-studied and most famous dinosaurs in the world.

Tyrannosaurus's big, bulky body; well-muscled legs; and powerful bite made it the top predator of its time, and it could even take down the most sizeable prey, such as *Edmontosaurus*.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 39 ft (12 m)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 67–66 MYA
- **HABITAT** Subtropical forests and coastal swamps

